PRINCIPLED AI · OPERATIONAL RESULTS

MARKET RESEARCH · OCTOBER 2026

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT · BRITISH COLUMBIA & ALBERTA

The independents' *window.*

What the large property managers in BC and Alberta already automate, where everyone else stands on AI, and the decisions a person must keep. Written for independent and mid-sized firms, from a five-person office to a 150-person regional manager, with the market data behind it.

44%
of 50 large Canadian multifamily operators say they have fully deployed AI (vendor-sponsored survey, 2026)

8%
of US property managers have fully automated any workflow (2026 survey)

18.7%
of Canadian real estate businesses used AI in the last year (2026)

9+
BC and Alberta management businesses or contract books bought by larger managers since 2023

$26B
rent paid each year by BC and Alberta renter households (estimate)

GEOGRAPHY
48 census divisions · 10 metro areas

DATA TO
October 2026

PREPARED BY
Work1.ai

01 · THE GAP

What the large operators already automate, *and how independent and mid-sized firms close the gap.*

The large operators (national managers, institutional owner-operators and the biggest regional firms) bought scale: central teams, standard systems and round-the-clock coverage. They hold a growing share of the market:

1 in 5

purpose-built units in Calgary and Edmonton belongs to a handful of owner-operators. FIRM FILINGS

1 in 7

BC strata lots: the equivalent of what the three largest strata managers that publish counts claim to manage. FIRM-STATED

9+

BC and Alberta management businesses, divisions or contract books bought by national and regional managers since 2023.

Each row below is a piece of that scale an independent or mid-sized firm can now reach with AI, as long as a person keeps the decisions that matter. We give no time-savings estimates: nothing is promised until it has been measured in the firm itself.

WORK	HOW LARGE OPERATORS RUN IT	COMMON PATTERN BELOW NATIONAL SCALE	WITH AI, GOVERNED
Leasing enquiries	Central leasing teams, CRM and virtual leasing agents. One large owner-operator reports tour-to-lease conversion up 33% and replies in minutes, not days. FIRM-STATED	Shared inbox and phone, answered in office hours by the same people who handle maintenance.	Every enquiry answered and qualified within minutes, showings booked to a calendar; a person approves the applicant.

WORK	HOW LARGE OPERATORS RUN IT	COMMON PATTERN BELOW NATIONAL SCALE	WITH AI, GOVERNED
Maintenance requests	Portals, triage rules, vendor networks; one large commercial landlord reports 4–6% energy savings and 10–15% fewer work orders from building AI. FIRM-STATED	Calls and texts to the manager's phone; trade choice from memory.	Requests logged, sorted by urgency and drafted as work orders with the right trade; a person approves spend over a set limit.
Rent and arrears	Pre-authorised debit, portals and automatic reminders.	A mix of debit, e-Transfer and cheques, matched by hand.	Payments matched to tenants, reminders sent on schedule; a person decides on every notice.
Trust accounting	Central accounting teams and enterprise systems.	Monthly reconciliation in the PM software and spreadsheets.	Reconciliation prepared and exceptions flagged; the managing broker reviews and initials it, as BC's rules require.
Owner reporting	Owner portals and standard monthly packs.	Statements assembled by hand, explained by phone.	Statements with a plain-language summary of what happened and why, drafted from the system's own data.
Compliance calendar	Compliance staff and central calendars.	Dates held per building, in calendars and in people's heads.	One calendar of every deadline (depreciation reports, insurance certificates, rent-increase windows, AGMs), with reminders and drafts ready.
Tenant and council communication	Contact centres and resident apps.	Personal and responsive, but bound to a few people's hours.	Consistent drafts and notices, translation where needed; sensitive messages are always sent by a person.

The middle column describes patterns that are common across the industry. It is not a description of any one firm.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Scale used to be the only way to run a portfolio efficiently. *AI changes what scale was buying.*

National and institutional operators pay for central leasing teams, 24–hour response, standard owner reporting and compliance staff. Much of that work is reading, sorting, drafting and checking, which is exactly what AI now does well. A firm below national scale that has written down how it works can buy that capability without the overhead, and keep the personal service that wins owners in the first place.

THE CONSTRAINT

Manager time

Units per manager, not demand, limits growth for most independent firms.

THE LEVER

Written-down work

A process someone else could follow is a process software can help with.

THE SAFEGUARD

Decide first

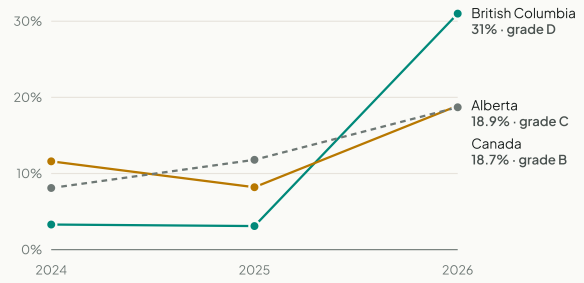
Name the decisions a person must keep before anything is automated.

Mostly one ledger, *and AI that has barely started.*

By its vendor's account, Canadian property management runs largely on one family of accounting software, with marketing, screening and resident portals bolted on around it. AI use is growing quickly from a low base, and most of it is chat and analytics, not automated work.

Businesses that used AI in the past 12 months

Real estate and rental and leasing, second quarter of each year. Letters are Statistics Canada's quality grades. STATISTICS CANADA



BC's 31.0% for 2026 carries grade D and follows 3.1% a year earlier, so treat it as volatile. The sector also includes lessors and equipment rental. Canada's all-industry average was 19.2% in 2026.

The software stack

The ledger. Yardi says it "holds the majority of the market share for residential and commercial real estate software solutions in Canada", and has sold Breeze here since 2018. Buildium (part of RealPage), Entrata, MRI and Rent Manager are present. AppFolio reports its revenue comes "primarily from United States customers". VENDOR-STATED

Around the ledger. Canadian tools handle listings (Rentsync, which owns Rentals.ca and RentFaster.ca), leasing (Rhenti), screening and rent guarantees (SingleKey), rent reporting (FrontLobby) and BC listings (liv.rent). Strata firms add BuildingLink, Condo Control, PowerStrata and StrataStation.

Rent payment. No source measures how Canadians pay rent. Among people who still write cheques regularly, rent is the most common reason. PAYMENTS CANADA

Large operators. In a vendor-sponsored survey of 50 large Canadian multifamily operators, 44% said they had fully deployed AI, and only 11% relied on their property management software for it. ELISEAI, 2026 Among US property managers, 33% use AI or automation. BUILDIUM/NARPM 2027 REPORT, US

03 · WHAT TO DO NEXT

Decide before you automate. *Measure before anyone promises savings.*

The firms that will gain most are not the ones that buy the most tools. They are the ones that know how their work is done, who decides what, and where their information lives. That is where we start with every firm.

FIRST

Map the work

We sit with the people who run the day-to-day and write down how leasing, maintenance, accounting and owner work actually happen, and where the hours go.

THEN

Write down the decisions

For each workflow: what starts it, what "done right" looks like, and when a person must step in. The same documents train a new hire and guide any automation.

ONLY THEN

Automate, measured and governed

Start with one workflow, measure it before and after, and keep the human checkpoints the rules and your clients expect.

Start with one workflow.

Pick the workflow that takes your team the most time, and we start there with you: how it runs today, the decisions in it, and where a person must stay in the loop.

work1.ai

Start with one workflow

Or book a free 45–minute call

Where a person must stay *in the loop.*

Property management is licensed work with a trust account at its centre. Some decisions are a person's by law, and others should stay with a person by choice. Good AI design starts from that list.

RULE	WHAT IT REQUIRES	WHERE A PERSON STAYS
BC Real Estate Services Rules, s.80(c) and s.72(2)	Monthly trust reconciliation prepared within five weeks of month-end, then reviewed, dated and initialled by a managing broker or their designate.	The sign-off
BCFSA guidance on licensed activity	Collecting rent and deposits is rental property management, a licensed activity.	It cannot be handed to an unlicensed third party, software provider included
BC Residential Tenancy Act	Landlord-use, purchaser-use and caretaker notices are generated through the government's web portal (since 18 July 2024); landlord-use notices give three months (since 18 June 2025).	The decision to end a tenancy
Alberta Residential Tenancies Act	No rent cap; one increase per 365 days; notices dated and signed by the landlord.	The signature
BC Strata Property Act	Depreciation reports every five years; the 2026 deadline has passed in the three largest districts, the rest are due by 1 July 2027; 10% minimum contingency contribution.	Council decisions and owner votes
Alberta Condominium Property Act	Amendments in force 15 February 2026; condominium dispute tribunal open since 1 April 2026, funded at $9 per unit per year.	Board resolutions, chargebacks
BCFSA AI Guideline (22 February 2024)	Warns that tenant-screening AI "may inadvertently rank individuals differently based on factors like race, gender, or language", and that vendors could reuse strata data.	Screening decisions and vendor choice
Competition Bureau guidance on algorithmic pricing	Overriding a price recommendation should be no harder than accepting it.	Rent-setting
Federal AI law	The proposed Artificial Intelligence and Data Act died in January 2025. The privacy bill tabled in June 2026, still at first reading, adds transparency for automated decisions but no AI act.	Firms set their own guardrails for now
BC PST on property management (Budget 2026)	Announced for non-residential property management, then paused on 18 September 2026 with no end date.	A risk to watch for commercial managers

APPENDIX · THE EVIDENCE · A1

A large market, run by small firms, *on the edge of a shift.*

The rest of this report is the evidence behind sections 01 to 04: the market, where the rent and the managers are, who manages, and how the work gets done.

British Columbia and Alberta renters pay about $26 billion a year in rent. Most of the businesses that manage those homes are small: well over half have fewer than five staff. The large operators are consolidating and centralising, and they have started to use AI to answer, triage and report at a scale no small office can staff. The same tools are now within reach of independent and mid-sized firms. What decides who benefits is not size, it is whether the work is written down well enough to hand to software.

RENT PAID

$26.0B

BC $15.9B · Alberta $10.1B

Renter households × average rent, per year.

ESTIMATE

THROUGH A MANAGER

$7.1B

range $4.0B – $9.7B

Rent on homes run by a third-party manager.

ASSUMPTION RANGE

MANAGEMENT FEE POOL

$0.94B

range $0.54B – $1.40B

Residential and strata management fees, per year.

ASSUMPTION RANGE

INDUSTRY REVENUE

$3.0B

BC $1.92B · Alberta $1.08B (2024)

All property-manager revenue, including commercial and on-site services.

STATISTICS CANADA

What the research says

Most rent never passes a professional manager

Of the $26B paid in rent, we estimate $4B to $10B goes through a third-party manager. The rest sits with owners who manage their own homes, from a basement suite to a 500-suite portfolio. That remainder is the growth market for every firm, large or small.

A market of micro-firms

BC has 976 property-management locations with employees and Alberta 672. 57% have one to four staff and only 76 have fifty or more. Another 6,001 operate with no employees at all.

STATISTICS CANADA, JUNE 2026

Three districts hold 70% of the rent

Metro Vancouver ($10.4B), the Calgary region ($4.4B) and the Edmonton region ($3.6B) account for seven of every ten rent dollars. Greater Victoria and Central Okanagan follow. The map shows every district.

Alberta tenancies turn over twice as fast

In purpose-built rentals, 24.7% of Calgary units and 27.8% of Edmonton units changed tenants in the past year, against 11.6% in Metro Vancouver. Lethbridge reached 37.8%. Every move-out is a listing, a showing, an inspection, a deposit and a lease.

CMHC, OCT 2025

Supply is growing faster than managers

Rental starts in Alberta's larger centres rose from 3,026 in 2020 to 19,681 in 2025. BC's strata sector has 807,738 strata lots, and its condo owners' association said in 2023 the province "could use 300 more managers tomorrow".

The big operators are pulling ahead

In Calgary and Edmonton, a handful of owner-operators run about one in five purpose-built units. The three largest BC strata managers that publish counts claim the equivalent of about one in seven strata lots. National and regional managers have bought at least nine BC and Alberta management businesses, divisions or contract books since 2023.

AI use in real estate is rising, but shallow

18.7% of Canadian real estate businesses used AI in 2026, slightly below the 19.2% average for all industries. Real estate was ahead of the economy in 2024 (8.1% against 6.1%) and has now fallen just behind. In the US, only 8% of property managers had fully automated any workflow. STATISTICS CANADA

BUILDIUM SURVEY

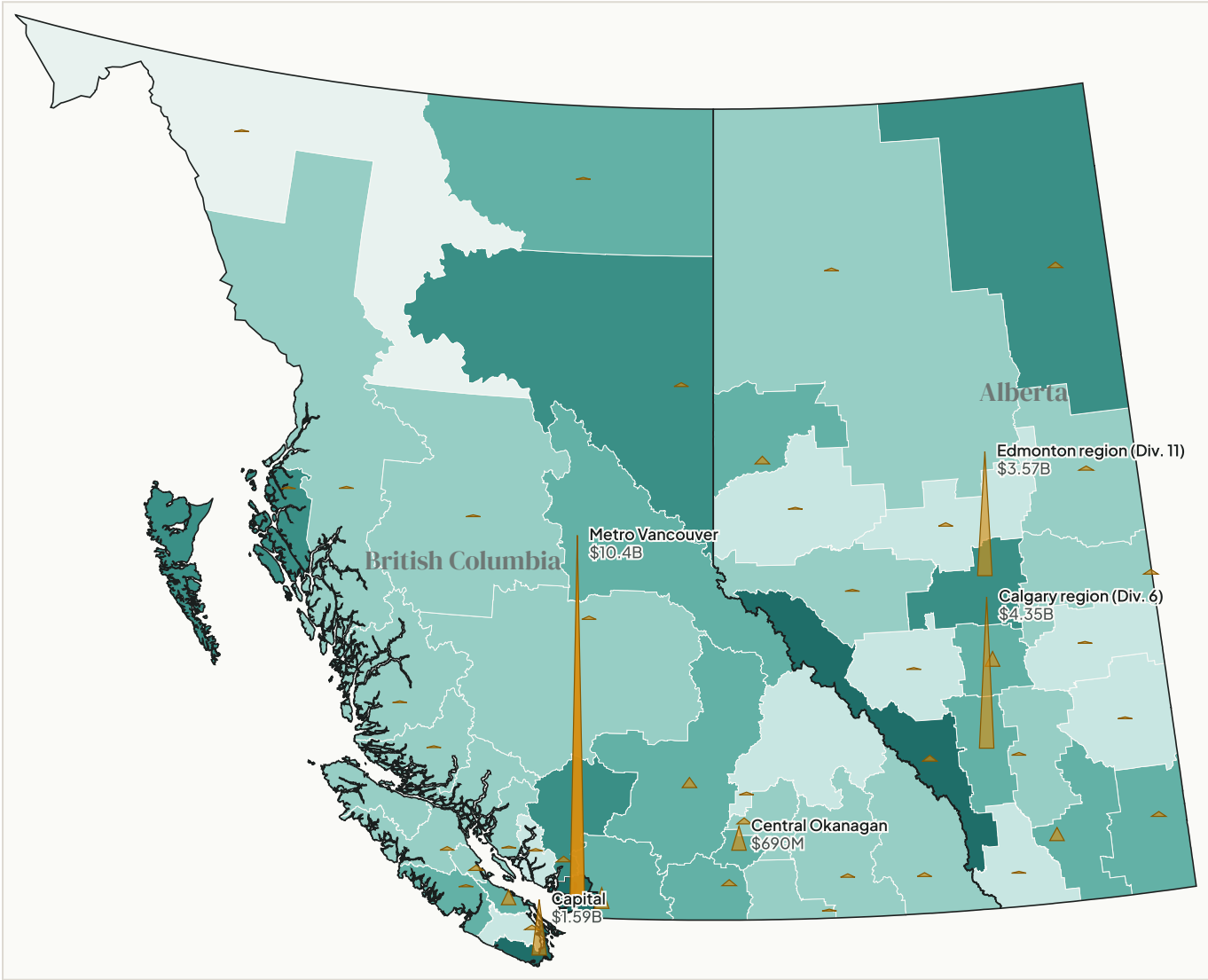
The rules keep a person in the loop

In BC, a managing broker or someone they designate signs off every monthly trust reconciliation. Collecting rent is licensed work. BC's regulator has issued AI guidance warning about bias in tenant screening. No AI-specific law yet applies, so firms that set their own guardrails now will not have to retrofit them later.

A2 · WHERE THE MONEY IS

Rent, renters and managers, *district by district.*

Each spike stands on a census division (a regional district in BC). Its height is the selected total. The shading underneath shows how much of the district rents, so a tall spike on dark ground is a large, renter-heavy market. Hover or tap a district for its figures.



Spike height: rent paid per year Shading: share of households renting (2021)

<15% → 40%+

Rent paid = renter households (Census 2021, grown with population to 2025) × average rent (CMHC Oct 2025 where a surveyed centre exists, otherwise census shelter cost grown with CMHC rents). Fee pool is the base case of the assumption ranges in Method & sources. PM businesses are property-manager locations with employees, June 2026, apportioned from the wider real-estate-management industry

group. Boundaries adapted from Statistics Canada, 2021 Census Cartographic Boundary Files. This does not constitute an endorsement by Statistics Canada of this product.

Every district

DISTRICT	PROV.	RENTER HOUSEHOI	RENTER SHARE	AVG RENT	RENT PAID / YR	FEE POOL / YR (LOW – HIGH)	PM BUSINESSE	POP. GROWTH 2021–25
Metro Vancouver	BC	439,655	37.8%	$1,970	$10.4B	$390M $210M – $577M	620	11.4%
Calgary region (Div. 6)	AB	204,542	28.6%	$1,773	$4.35B	$144M $87.3M – $219M	293	18.3%
Edmonton region (Div. 11)	AB	199,749	30.8%	$1,490	$3.57B	$127M $77.9M – $191M	245	14.5%
Capital	BC	73,281	36.9%	$1,812	$1.59B	$61.6M $38.1M – $90.9M	69	7.1%
Central Okanagan	BC	30,168	29.2%	$1,906	$690M	$28.8M $18.1M – $42.4M	57	9.7%
Fraser Valley	BC	34,929	27.1%	$1,422	$596M	$24.5M $15.6M – $36.1M	28	9.1%
Red Deer region (Div. 8)	AB	25,514	28.0%	$1,386	$424M	$14.5M $8.6M – $21.9M	28	8.4%
Nanaimo	BC	21,153	26.4%	$1,668	$424M	$15.6M $9.6M – $23.2M	17	6.3%
Lethbridge region (Div. 2)	AB	20,660	28.3%	$1,525	$378M	$12.0M $7.0M – $18.1M	19	9.7%
Thompson-Nicola	BC	16,099	25.5%	$1,503	$290M	$10.9M $6.8M – $16.1M	26	5.6%
Grande Prairie region (Div. 19)	AB	13,162	27.1%	$1,392	$220M	$7.2M $4.2M – $10.8M	16	5.3%
Fraser-Fort George	BC	11,967	28.0%	$1,354	$194M	$6.3M $3.8M – $9.4M	13	6.3%
Okanagan-Similkameen	BC	10,447	25.1%	$1,387	$174M	$6.5M $4.1M – $9.7M	10	1.4%
North Okanagan	BC	10,095	24.6%	$1,406	$170M	$6.1M $3.8M – $9.1M	16	5.5%
Canmore region (Div. 15)	AB	6,009	36.7%	$2,319	$167M	$4.9M $2.9M – $7.5M	15	8.6%
Squamish-Lillooet	BC	6,699	31.5%	$2,001	$161M	$5.5M $3.4M – $8.1M	25	6.4%
Wood Buffalo region (Div. 16)	AB	9,375	32.5%	$1,426	$160M	$6.5M $4.0M – $9.8M	8	8.3%
Comox Valley	BC	7,718	22.6%	$1,622	$150M	$5.8M $3.6M – $8.5M	9	6.8%
Medicine Hat region (Div. 1)	AB	9,601	27.1%	$1,224	$141M	$5.2M $3.1M – $7.8M	12	4.9%
Lloydminster region (Div. 10)	AB	8,880	22.4%	$1,280	$136M	$4.3M $2.5M – $6.5M	10	4.0%
Cowichan Valley	BC	7,682	19.8%	$1,377	$127M	$4.4M $2.7M – $6.5M	5	4.1%

DISTRICT	PROV.	RENTER HOUSEHOI	RENTER SHARE	AVG RENT	RENT PAID / YR	FEE POOL / YR (LOW – HIGH)	PM BUSINESSE	POP. GROWTH 2021–25
Division No. 12	AB	6,188	23.3%	$1,590	$118M	$2.8M $1.6M – $4.3M	3	3.7%
East Kootenay	BC	6,459	21.5%	$1,434	$111M	$3.7M $2.3M – $5.6M	18	6.1%
Peace River	BC	8,235	31.5%	$1,108	$109M	$4.0M $2.4M – $5.9M	11	5.0%
Strathcona	BC	5,465	24.8%	$1,556	$102M	$3.5M $2.2M – $5.3M	5	3.9%
Central Kootenay	BC	6,546	22.0%	$1,253	$98.4M	$2.6M $1.5M – $4.0M	6	6.0%
Division No. 13	AB	5,327	18.7%	$1,514	$96.8M	$2.5M $1.4M – $3.8M	6	3.8%
Cariboo	BC	6,158	21.9%	$1,266	$93.5M	$2.5M $1.5M – $3.8M	6	2.0%
Strathmore region (Div. 5)	AB	4,477	20.5%	$1,467	$78.8M	$2.2M $1.3M – $3.4M	3	7.0%
Division No. 17	AB	4,450	20.9%	$1,475	$78.8M	$1.8M $1.0M – $2.8M	2	3.7%
Columbia-Shuswap	BC	5,187	19.9%	$1,235	$76.9M	$2.4M $1.4M – $3.6M	10	6.1%
Sunshine Coast	BC	3,083	19.8%	$1,846	$68.3M	$2.0M $1.2M – $3.0M	6	4.3%
Alberni-Clayoquot	BC	4,143	27.3%	$1,184	$58.9M	$1.8M $1.1M – $2.8M	4	4.0%
Kitimat-Stikine	BC	3,642	22.1%	$1,274	$55.7M	$1.5M $886k – $2.3M	1	7.4%
Division No. 14	AB	2,767	23.8%	$1,594	$52.9M	$1.3M $761k – $2.1M	3	0.8%
Division No. 7	AB	3,073	18.9%	$1,415	$52.2M	$1.3M $709k – $2.0M	1	0.8%
Bulkley-Nechako	BC	3,279	21.2%	$1,261	$49.6M	$1.2M $711k – $1.9M	4	0.4%
Division No. 3	AB	2,661	18.4%	$1,364	$43.5M	$1.1M $585k – $1.6M	3	1.9%
Kootenay Boundary	BC	3,113	20.0%	$951	$35.5M	$1.2M $704k – $1.7M	5	2.6%
Skeena-Queen Charlotte	BC	2,437	31.7%	$1,064	$31.1M	$949k $558k – $1.4M	3	0.3%
Powell River	BC	2,297	22.0%	$1,098	$30.3M	$940k $564k – $1.4M	1	3.9%
Division No. 9	AB	1,514	17.9%	$1,406	$25.5M	$645k $357k – $992k	3	3.7%
Division No. 18	AB	979	19.1%	$1,529	$18.0M	$478k $269k – $735k	0	2.6%
Mount Waddington	BC	1,209	24.6%	$1,095	$15.9M	$507k $308k – $761k	1	0.8%
Division No. 4	AB	694	19.2%	$1,182	$9.8M	$262k $144k – $403k	1	-0.1%

DISTRICT	PROV.	RENTER HOUSEHOI	RENTER SHARE	AVG RENT	RENT PAID / YR	FEE POOL / YR (LOW – HIGH)	PM BUSINESSE	POP. GROWTH 2021–25
Northern Rockies	BC	549	28.4%	$1,074	$7.1M	$185k $107k – $281k	1	0.7%
Central Coast	BC	307	20.8%	$948	$3.5M	$66k $37k – $101k	0	6.0%
Stikine	BC	50	12.2%	$801	$483k	$12k $6k – $18k	0	11.6%

A3 · METRO AREAS

Ten markets, *three different jobs.*

Metro Vancouver is a large, slow-turning market where condos carry much of the rental stock. Calgary and Edmonton are fast-growing and fast-turning, with the most new purpose-built supply. The smaller BC and Alberta centres are tight, personal markets where one firm's reputation can cover a whole town.

Metro Vancouver — BC

Purpose-built rental units	129,351
Average rent	$1,970
Vacancy	3.7%
Tenant turnover	11.6%
Condos rented out	33.9%
District rent paid / yr	$10.4B
PM businesses in district	620

The largest and slowest-turning market. 107,192 condos are in the rental pool, close to the number of purpose-built units.

Victoria — BC

Purpose-built rental units	34,759
Average rent	$1,812
Vacancy	3.3%
Tenant turnover	18.6%
Condos rented out	27.1%
District rent paid / yr	$1.59B
PM businesses in district	69

Purpose-built stock up 23% since 2020. Older stratas in the Capital region were due a depreciation report by 1 July 2026.

Kelowna — BC

Purpose-built rental units	10,680
Average rent	$1,906
Vacancy	6.3%
Tenant turnover	28.7%
Condos rented out	31.3%
District rent paid / yr	$690M
PM businesses in district	57

The highest vacancy of the ten after its stock grew 44% since 2020. A leasing market, not a waiting list.

Abbotsford–Mission — BC

Purpose-built rental units	5,946
Average rent	$1,447
Vacancy	3.1%
Tenant turnover	9.4%
District rent paid / yr	$596M
PM businesses in district	28

Low turnover and a small purpose-built stock. In the Fraser Valley district most rentals are suites, houses and condos.

Chilliwack

BC

Purpose-built rental units	4,166
Average rent	$1,386
Vacancy	3.0%
Tenant turnover	10.6%
District rent paid / yr	$596M
PM businesses in district	28

Same district as Abbotsford-Mission. Purpose-built stock up 22% since 2020.

Nanaimo

BC

Purpose-built rental units	5,891
Average rent	$1,688
Vacancy	2.2%
Tenant turnover	23.5%
District rent paid / yr	$424M
PM businesses in district	17

The tightest vacancy of the ten, with stock up 36% since 2020.

Calgary

AB

Purpose-built rental units	67,980
Average rent	$1,775
Vacancy	4.9%
Tenant turnover	24.7%
Condos rented out	34.7%
District rent paid / yr	$4.35B
PM businesses in district	293

The fastest-growing stock: up 48% since 2020, with 9,841 rental starts in 2025.

Edmonton

AB

Purpose-built rental units	102,108
Average rent	$1,493
Vacancy	3.8%
Tenant turnover	27.8%
Condos rented out	36.6%
District rent paid / yr	$3.57B
PM businesses in district	245

The largest purpose-built market outside Vancouver, and 8,922 rental starts in 2025.

Red Deer

AB

Purpose-built rental units	7,152
Average rent	$1,379
Vacancy	3.2%
Tenant turnover	21.3%
District rent paid / yr	$424M
PM businesses in district	28

A stable stock (up 3% since 2020). Lower rents mean thinner fees per unit.

Lethbridge

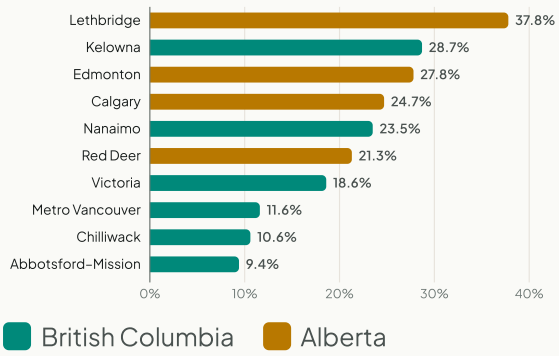
AB

Purpose-built rental units	4,543
Average rent	$1,549
Vacancy	4.2%
Tenant turnover	37.8%
District rent paid / yr	$378M
PM businesses in district	19

The highest turnover in either province: more than a third of units changed tenants in a year.

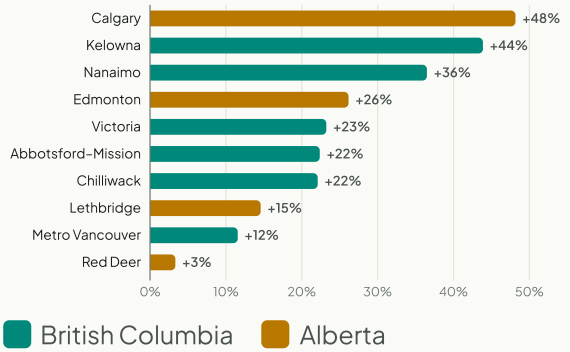
Tenant turnover, purpose-built rentals

Share of units that changed tenants in the year to October 2025. CMHC



Growth in purpose-built rental units, 2020–2025

Rental universe, October 2020 to October 2025. CMHC



A4 · WHO MANAGES

Four kinds of operator. *One long tail.*

We group operators into four bands instead of naming them. Size comes from what each band manages in the districts it covers. Independents are by far the largest band by number of firms, and regional managers carry most of the managed units outside the national firms. This report is written for both: every firm below the national scale.

INSTITUTIONAL OWNER-OPERATORS

REITs, pension funds and public housing

Own and run their own buildings. They are not competitors for management contracts, but they set what tenants expect.

- About one in five purpose-built units in Calgary and Edmonton belongs to a handful of them. FIRM FILINGS
- Public and non-profit providers run more than 68,000 homes in BC (2022) and about 12,000 in Calgary and Edmonton.
- In-house apps, central call centres and new ERP systems.

NATIONAL MANAGERS

Three or more provinces

Strata, rental and commercial managers with national back offices, proprietary portals and acquisition programmes.

- Earn much of their revenue from services around the building. At one listed national manager, management fees are 16% of revenue and on-site services 56%. ANNUAL REPORT
- At least nine acquisitions of BC and Alberta management businesses, divisions or contract books since 2023, by national and regional buyers.

REGIONAL MANAGERS

1,000+ units, one or two provinces

Mid-sized and large strata and rental managers, mostly in Metro Vancouver, Calgary and Edmonton. The largest of them are consolidating.

- 224 property-manager locations have 20 to 199 employees. STATISTICS CANADA
- The three largest BC strata managers that publish counts claim about 120,000 managed units between them, mostly strata. That is the equivalent of about one in seven of BC's 807,738 strata lots. FIRM-STATED
- In Alberta the three largest claim about 66,000 condo units, about one in five condo homes. FIRM-STATED

INDEPENDENTS

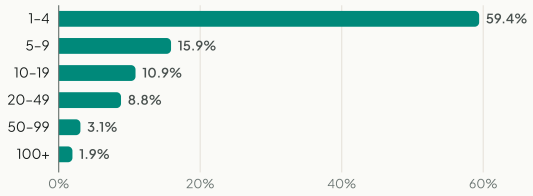
Under 1,000 units

Owner-led firms and brokerage divisions, often in one district. Their edge is local knowledge and personal service.

- 932 of the 1,648 employer locations have one to four staff, plus 6,001 with no employees. STATISTICS CANADA
- Fees cluster at 10% of rent; leasing at half a month's rent in BC.

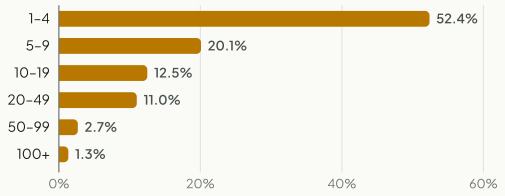
Property-manager businesses by number of employees, BC

Locations with employees, June 2026 (976).
STATISTICS CANADA



Property-manager businesses by number of employees, Alberta

Locations with employees, June 2026 (672).
STATISTICS CANADA



Firm-stated unit counts are each firm's own claim and may overlap where two firms count the same building over time. We treat them as upper bounds. Counts are business locations, not companies. Statistics Canada advises against reading its business counts as a time series.

A5 · HOW THE WORK GETS DONE

A fee of about ten per cent, *and a calendar full of deadlines.*

Residential management is priced as a share of rent, with separate charges for finding a tenant. Strata management is priced per unit per month. The work behind the fee is mostly coordination: tenants, owners, trades, councils, regulators and the trust account, each with its own dates.

10%

Most common monthly management fee, from 18 published fee schedules (range 8% to 12.5%, plus GST).

FIRM-STATED

½ month

Typical BC leasing fee. Alberta firms charge a flat $450 to $795. Renewals are often free, otherwise $100 to $250.

$35 · $25

Average strata or condo management fee per unit per month, BC and Alberta. One large Vancouver firm quotes $25 to $55 for full service.

INDUSTRY DATASET

26% · 23%

Industry operating margin, BC and Alberta, 2024 (preliminary). An industry total before tax, which counts sole owners' own pay as profit.

STATISTICS CANADA

Where the hours go

No Canadian survey measures how property managers spend their week, so we report what the volumes show:

Tenancy changes. At Alberta's turnover rates, a manager with 150 apartment units handles roughly 37 to 42 move-outs and new leases a year. In Metro Vancouver it is closer to 17.

Disputes. Alberta's tenancy dispute service received 15,239 filings in 2024/25, up from 10,973 four years earlier; about 73% were landlords seeking possession. BC's Residential Tenancy Branch now hears 78.6% of disputes within its service standard, up from 5.2% in 2021/22. GOVERNMENT

Strata deadlines. Every BC strata corporation needs a depreciation report every five years. Those without one since 2020 had to have one by 1 July 2026 in Capital, Fraser Valley and Metro Vancouver, and must have one before 1 July 2027 elsewhere. GOVERNMENT

Benchmarks. In the US, property managers run about 49 units per staff member on average and 59 in the top quarter of firms. NARPM, US, 2021

Recurring work a typical firm carries

What the rules and the market create each year

CYCLE	WORK
Daily	Tenant messages, maintenance requests, trade dispatch, showing requests
Monthly	Rent collection and arrears, trust reconciliation within five weeks of month-end (BC), owner statements
Per tenancy	Listing, screening, lease, move-in and move-out inspections, deposit return
Annual	Rent increases (BC cap 2.3% for 2026, 2.2% for 2027; Alberta once every 365 days), insurance certificates, strata AGMs and budgets, brokerage accountant's report (BC)
Multi-year	Depreciation reports (BC) and reserve fund studies (Alberta)

Start with one workflow.

Pick the workflow that takes your team the most time, and we start there with you: how it runs today, the decisions in it, and where a person must stay in the loop.

work1.ai

Start with one workflow

Or book a free 45-minute call

METHOD & SOURCES

How the numbers were built.

Every figure on this page carries its source type: STATISTICS CANADA or CMHC data, GOVERNMENT or regulator publications, FIRM-STATED claims by companies about themselves, SURVEY results from industry or vendor surveys, and ESTIMATE or ASSUMPTION RANGE for our own calculations. No property management firm is named. Software vendors are.

District estimates

1. **Renter households** per census division from the 2021 Census, grown by each division's population growth to 2025 (Statistics Canada estimates).
2. **Average rent** from CMHC's October 2025 Rental Market Survey for divisions with a surveyed centre, weighted by units; elsewhere, the 2021 census average shelter cost for renters (which includes utilities) grown by CMHC's 2020–2025 provincial rent growth. Rent paid = households × rent × 12.
3. **Purpose-built rentals** from CMHC's rental universe, minus known self-managed units of large owner-operators and public housing providers. Secondary rentals (condos, suites, houses) are renter households minus purpose-built and subsidised units.
4. **Share run by a third-party manager**: no Canadian source publishes it, so we use a range. For Metro Vancouver, where several large owner-operators publish no counts, the low case uses a lower purpose-built share.
5. **Fee pool** = managed rent × management fee, plus leasing fees at each district's turnover rate, plus strata and condo units × the professionally managed share × the monthly per-unit fee × 12. Strata and condo units use census condominium dwellings in both provinces, so the provinces compare like with like. BC's official count of 807,738 strata lots is higher because it includes bare-land, commercial and other lots.
6. **PM businesses** per division are Statistics Canada's counts for the wider industry group (which includes appraisers and other real-estate services), scaled by each province's property-manager share.

ASSUMPTION	LOW	BASE	HIGH	WHY
Purpose-built units run by a third party (after known self-managers)	30%	45%	60%	Large owners mostly self-manage; smaller building owners often hire a manager
Secondary rentals run by a third party	15%	25%	35%	Most condo and suite owners self-manage. BC small investors hold 49.4% of rental property by assessed value

ASSUMPTION	LOW	BASE	HIGH	WHY
Strata and condo units professionally managed	70%	78%	85%	In 2023 about 22,000 of BC's 34,000 strata corporations were small and self-managed; small stratas hold few lots
Management fee, % of rent	8%	9%	10%	Published fee schedules; 10% is the most common rate, with discounts on larger portfolios
Strata fee per unit per month, BC / Alberta	$30 / $20	$35 / $25	$45 / $35	Industry dataset and published quotes

Check: the base-case fee pool ($0.94B) is about a third of Statistics Canada's $3.0B property-manager revenue for the two provinces. The rest is commercial management and services such as on-site staff, which this model leaves out.

Sources

STATISTICS CANADA

Canadian Business Counts, with and without employees, June 2026 (33-10-1174, 33-10-1176) NAICS 531310 and 5313, by employment size and municipality.

Real estate property managers, summary statistics (21-10-0221) Operating revenue and margin, 2024 (preliminary).

Census 2021 housing tables (98-10-0239, 98-10-0240, 98-10-0243) Tenure, condominium status, subsidised housing, shelter costs, by census division.

Population estimates by census division (17-10-0152) and by province (17-10-0005), September 2026 release.

Canadian Survey on Business Conditions, use of AI (33-10-0825, 33-10-1004, 33-10-1167) Q2 2024-2026.

Canadian Housing Statistics Program (46-10-0093, 46-10-0095) BC residential properties and investment use, 2024; ownership by assessed value, 2022.

Statistics Canada, 2021 Census Cartographic Boundary Files (census divisions; CMAs and CAs), via the Statistics Canada geography web service.

CMHC

Rental Market Report data tables 2025, British Columbia, Alberta and metro workbooks. Universe, rents, vacancy, turnover, condo rental pool; October 2020, 2024, 2025.

Housing Market Information Portal Starts and completions by intended market, 2020-2025.

REGULATORS AND GOVERNMENTS

BCFSA, licensing and enforcement statistics 2023 (licensees at 31 December 2023).

BCFSA, Artificial Intelligence Guideline (22 February 2024).

Real Estate Council of Alberta, Annual Report 2024-2025.

Land Title and Survey Authority of BC, strata property information (31 March 2026).

BC Real Estate Services Rules, ss. 72, 77 and 80.

BC government, rent increases and landlord notices to end tenancy.

BC government, strata depreciation reports and changes to strata legislation.

BC Budget 2026, Fiscal Plan, news release of 18 September 2026 and PST notice.

Residential Tenancy Branch and Alberta Residential Tenancy Dispute Resolution Service annual reports; Alberta Residential Tenancies Act and Condominium Property Act; Competition Bureau guidance on algorithmic pricing (2025).

INDUSTRY, VENDORS AND PRESS

Buildium, 2026 State of the Property Management Industry Report and the 2027 edition (with NARPM, US respondents).

RENX, on EliseAI's "The State of AI in Canada" (10 July 2026; vendor-sponsored, 50 operators).

Yardi Breeze Canada, “Yardi Canada celebrates 25 years” (19 March 2024).

Times Colonist, “B.C. suffering an acute shortage of strata managers” (25 March 2023).

Published fee schedules of 18 BC and Alberta property managers (2024–2026); NARPM operating benchmarks (US, 2021); Payments Canada cheque-use surveys.

Operator-level figures (unit counts, acquisitions and AI outcomes reported by specific firms) come from company filings, websites and press coverage. They are summarised by band so that no firm is singled out.